



THERAPIST → COACH

The Mindset Shift

A therapist-to-coach snapshot

Same depth, different lane. Six shifts in how you work, then how to package and price it – and the language that comes with the move.

01

From Remediation to Realization

THERAPY Focuses on healing, reducing distress, and restoring functioning.

COACHING Assumes the client is already psychologically stable, and helps them realize untapped potential, reach ambitious goals, and design the future they want.

EXAMPLE

A therapist helps a client manage anxiety after burnout. A coach helps that same client design a career that *energizes* them and aligns with their values.

02

From Diagnosis to Definition

THERAPY Relies on clinical assessment, diagnosis, and treatment planning.

COACHING Works from a coaching agreement — a clear definition of desired outcomes, success measures, roles, and responsibilities.

EXAMPLE

Therapy: treatment for generalized anxiety. Coaching: *build the confidence to speak on stage to an audience of 200 within 90 days.*

Therapy remains the foundation • Coaching becomes the expansion





03

From Hours to Outcomes

THERAPY Charges per session; time is the product.

COACHING Prices and structures the work around the value of the transformation, not the time spent.

EXAMPLE

A 90-day program that helps a physician stop over-functioning and reclaim two evenings a week with their family can be worth *far more* than the hourly total of the sessions.

04

From Open-Ended to Structured

THERAPY Often ongoing and adaptable, guided by the client's needs as they arise.

COACHING Follows a defined process — milestones, tools, and checkpoints — while leaving room for flexibility.

EXAMPLE

A 12-week program with weekly modules, progress tracking, and specific, agreed end goals.

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05

From Coping to Thriving

THERAPY Aims to help clients manage symptoms and maintain stability.

COACHING Focuses on breakthroughs, elevated performance, and building a life beyond “just coping.”

EXAMPLE

Therapy: rebuilding stability after a hard year. Coaching: *designing the next chapter* — the role, the pace, and the life they actually want.

06

Growth Mindset as a Foundation

THERAPY May address limiting beliefs in the context of mental health.

COACHING Embeds a growth mindset — that skills, habits, and outcomes are developed through effort, strategy, and feedback — into every stage of the work.

EXAMPLE

Helping a client read a business setback not as failure, but as *data* for a better approach next time.



07

Offer Design — Package the Transformation

Therapy works session to session, addressing issues as they arise, with no set “end product.”

Coaching builds a clear, structured offer around a **promised transformation**. Start with one flagship program using the three-box blueprint:

AUDIENCE	Narrow and specific — the exact type of client you serve.
OUTCOME	A measurable transformation the client can clearly recognize.
MECHANISM	Your repeatable method — the milestones, tools, and resources that carry them from start to finish.

08

Pricing — Value Over Time

Therapy traditionally charges by the hour, tying income to time spent. Coaching prices on the **value of the outcome**, not the clock.

VALUE-BASED	Anchor fees to client-perceived gains — results, avoided costs, speed to success, risk reduction.
AGREEMENT FIRST	Align on objectives, success measures, and logistics <i>before</i> quoting a price.
DE-RISK BY SCOPE	Protect your time with caps and milestone gates rather than lowering your price.

Therapy remains the foundation · Coaching becomes the expansion





09

Language Shift Cheat Sheet

Patient → Client

Diagnosis / treatment plan → Goals / outcomes

Intervention → Action

Session → Milestone / objective

Coping skills → Strategy / plan

At a Glance

THERAPIST LENS

COACHING LENS

Remediation

Realization

Diagnosis

Definition (goal & success measures)

Hourly billing

Outcome-based value

Open-ended sessions

Structured pathways

Coping

Thriving

Managing limitations

Expanding potential

The lane changes; the depth doesn't. Your clinical training is the edge – this is where you point it.